

Employee Onboarding Transformation

Business process transformation case study

Reducing onboarding cycle from 20 to 10 days

(Self-directed case study – developed to

demonstrate PMO methodology and capability)



Project Manager
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PMP Certified



Executive Portfolio



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Executive Summary

Project scope, objectives, deliverables and expected business outcomes.

Business Challenge

20-day onboarding cycle resulting in delayed employee productivity and an inconsistent onboarding experience

Objective

Reduce onboarding cycle **from 20 to 10 days** through **process redesign** and **automation**

Deliverables

Project Charter, Future-State Process, Project Plan, RAID Log and Change Plan

Expected Outcome

50% reduction in onboarding cycle
Standardized onboarding process
Improved **employee readiness**

My Role

Self-initiated case study

Independently designed and developed this case study to demonstrate end-to-end PMO capability, applying PMP-aligned methodology to a realistic onboarding transformation scenario

Designed the case scenario, problem statement, and success metrics

Led discovery approach and stakeholder mapping across HR, IT, Facilities, Payroll, Hiring Managers, and New Hires

Developed current-state and future-state process maps

Build the 5-phase implementation roadmap

Created the governance framework and PM artifacts (RAID log, decision log, change log, status reporting)

Business Challenges

Key issues identified during discovery

1

Long onboarding cycle

20-day average cycle

2

Sequential activities

Departments work sequentially

3

Manual coordination

Email-based coordination

4

Inconsistent process

Different onboarding practices

Discovery & Root Causes

Discovery interviews and root cause analysis

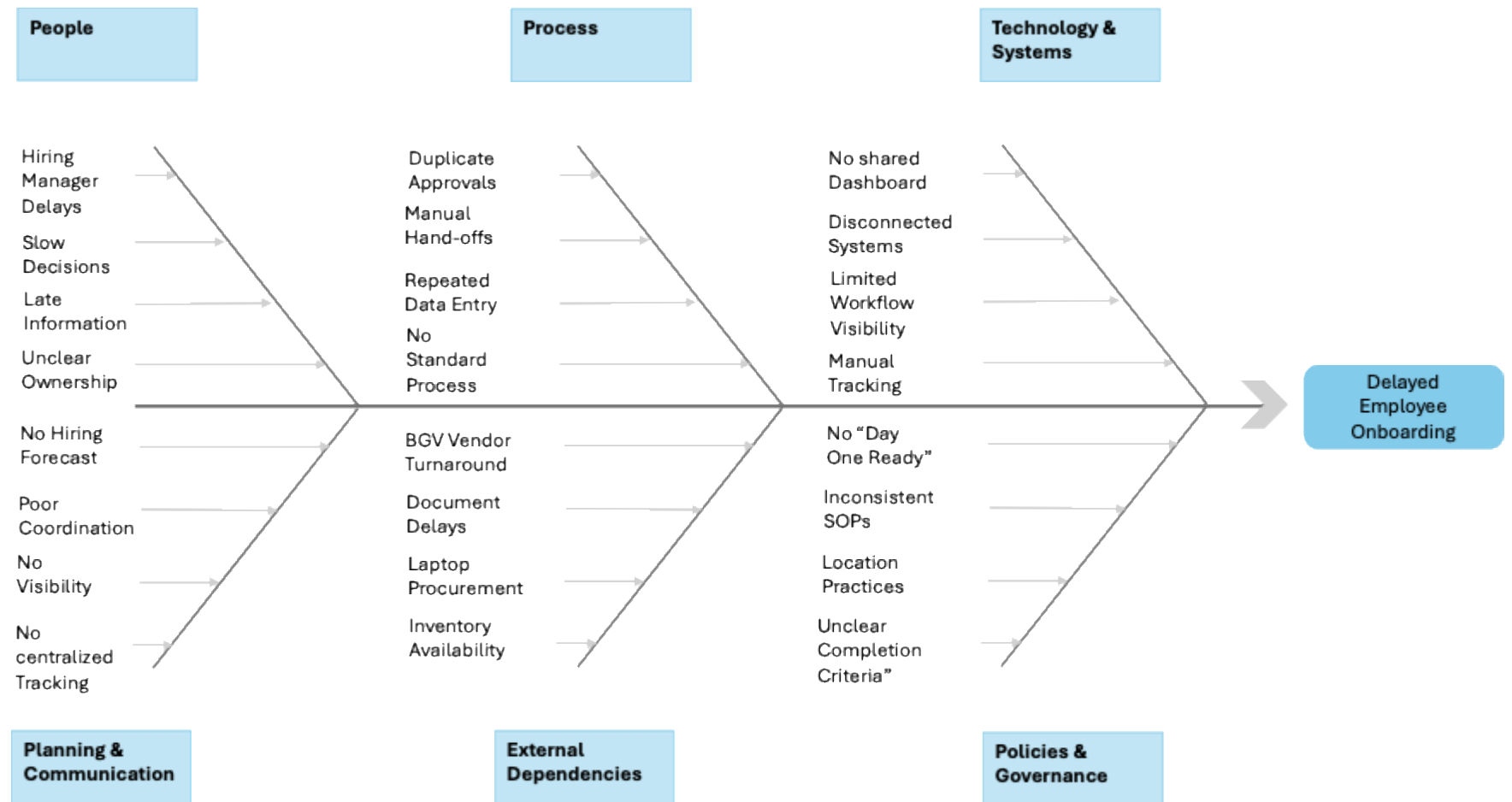
Stakeholder	Discovery Focus
HR	Recruitment & onboarding
IT	System access & equipment
Facilities	Workspace readiness
Payroll	Employee records
Hiring Managers	Team readiness
New Hires	Onboarding experience

Key Finding

Discovery confirmed that siloed processes and manual handoffs were the primary drivers of onboarding delays.

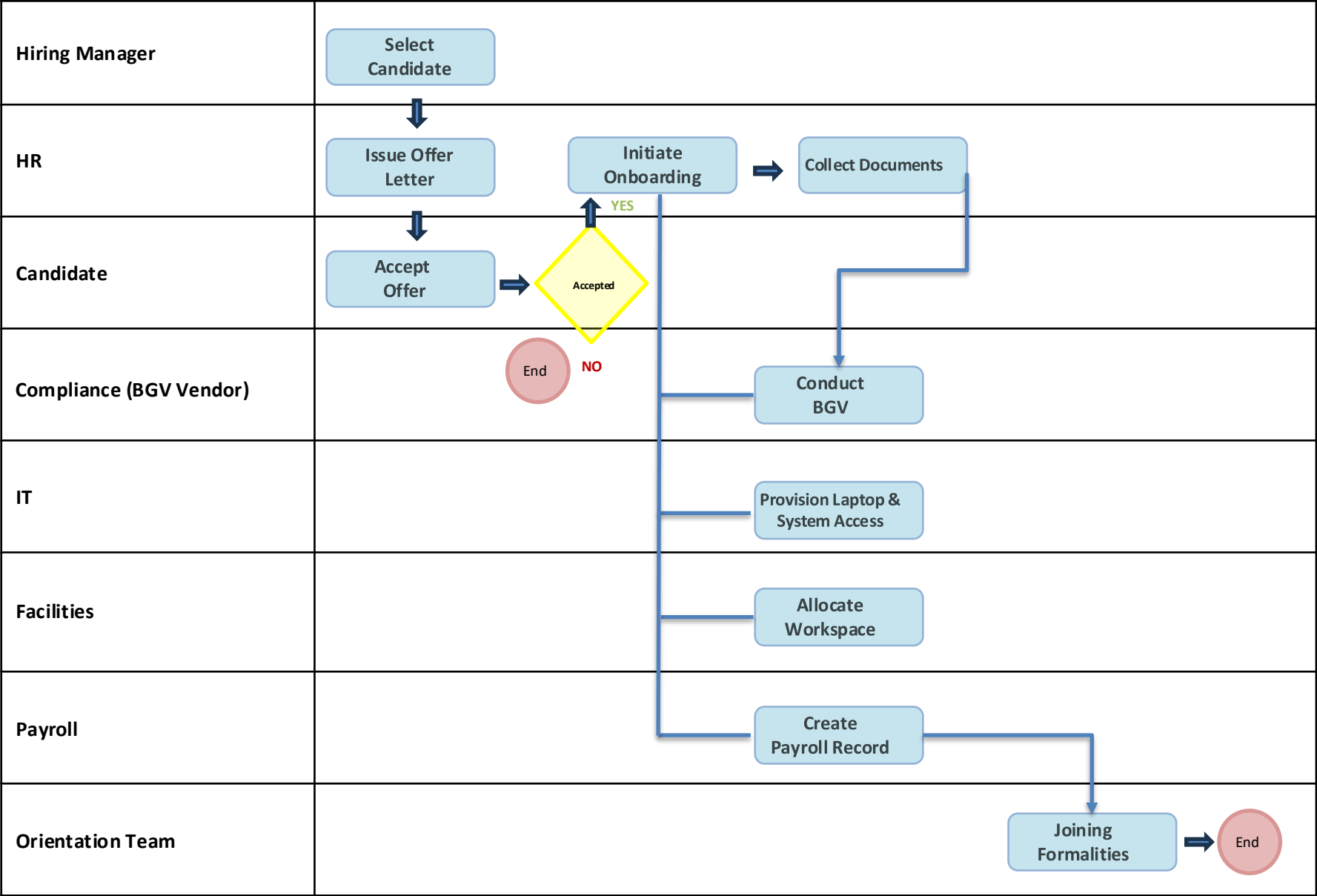
Fishbone Diagram

Traced onboarding delays to six root cause categories, validating discovery findings



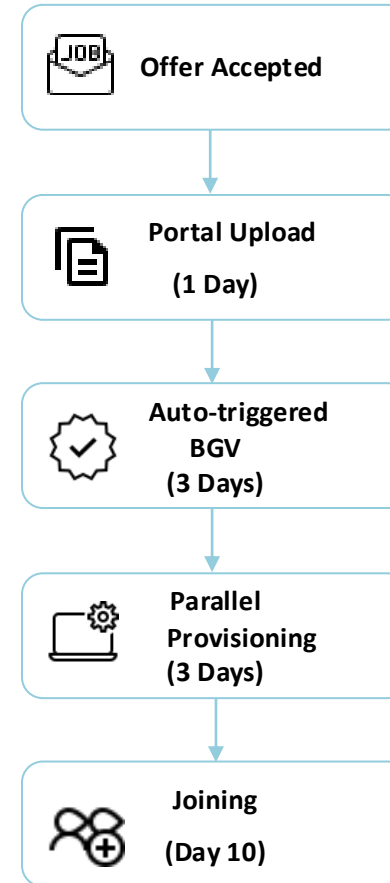
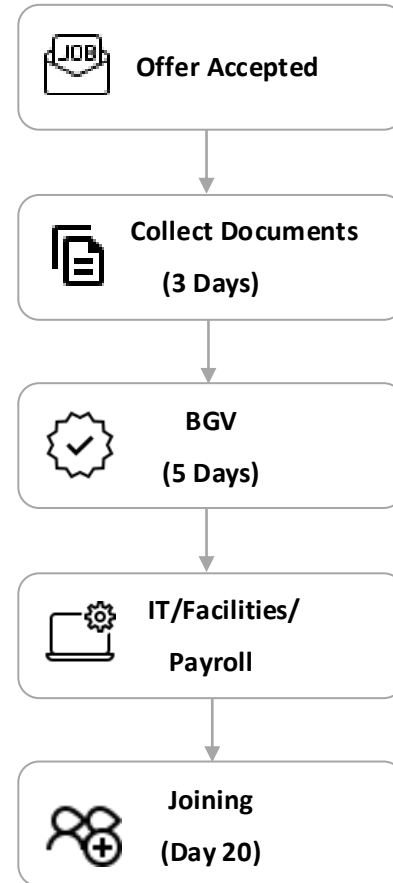
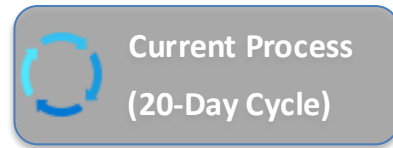
Current State Process

As-is onboarding process



Future State Process

Redesigned onboarding workflow



50% Faster
20 Days → 10 days
INR 37.5 L recovered

Parallel Activities

HR, IT, Payroll &
Facilities

Digital Automation

Portal-based
workflow

Standard Process

Consistent
onboarding across
locations

Cost Impact Analysis (INR)

Estimate based on illustrative assumptions for case study purposes

Assumptions

150 new hires/year

Average fully-loaded cost per new hire; INR **2500/day** (salary + overhead, pre-productivity)

Delayed onboarding = lost productive time, not just idle cost

Calculation

Cycle reduction = 20 days to 10 days
= 10 days saved per hire

Per hire savings: 10 days X INR 2500/day = INR **25,000**

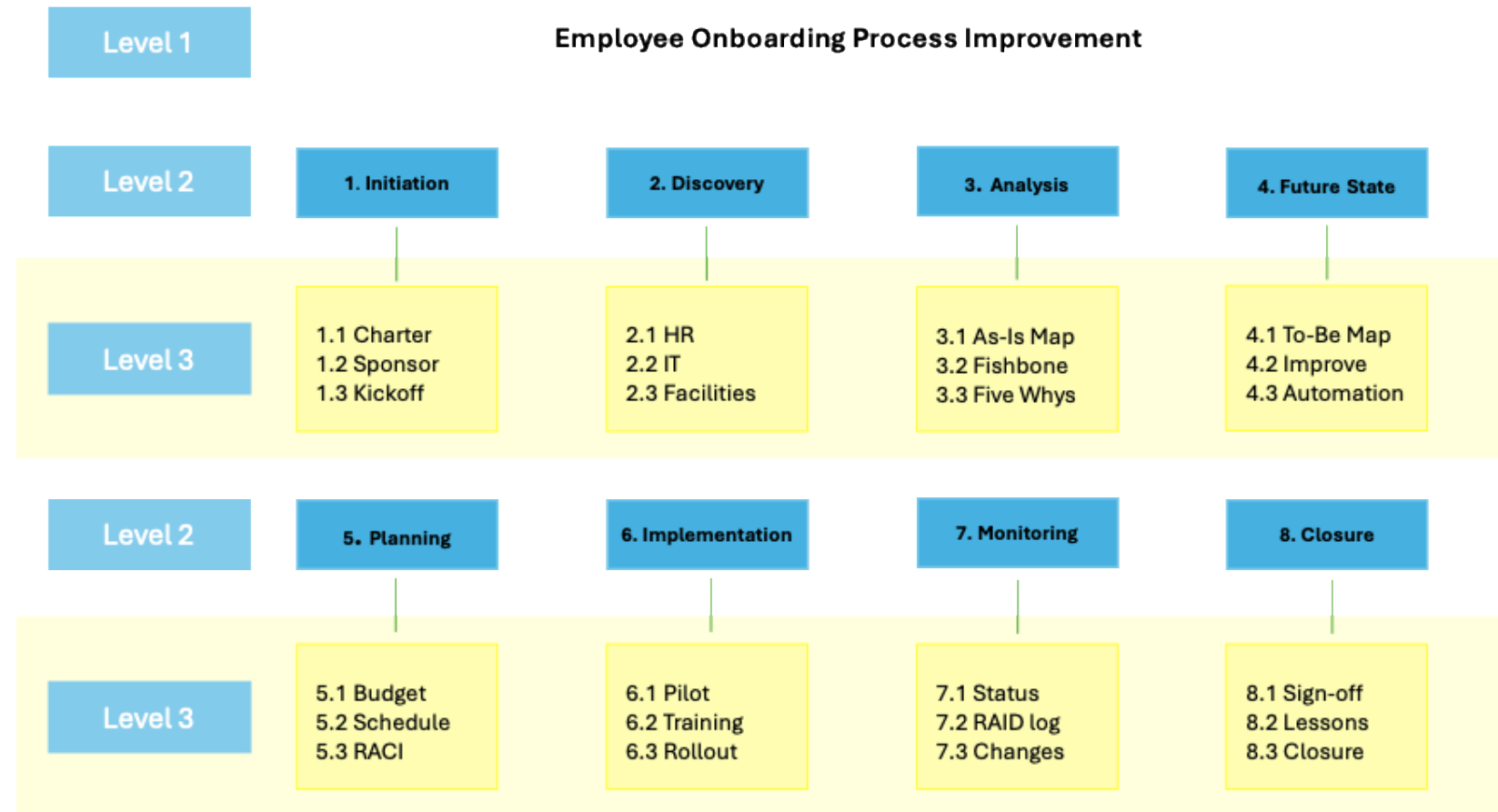
Annualized impact: INR25,000 X 150 hires = **INR 37.5 lakh/year** in recovered productivity

Reducing the onboarding cycle by 50% is estimated to recover **INR 37.5 lakh** annually in lost productivity across 150 new hires – in addition to the qualitative gains in consistency and new hire experience.

Estimate based on illustrative assumptions for case study purposes

Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)

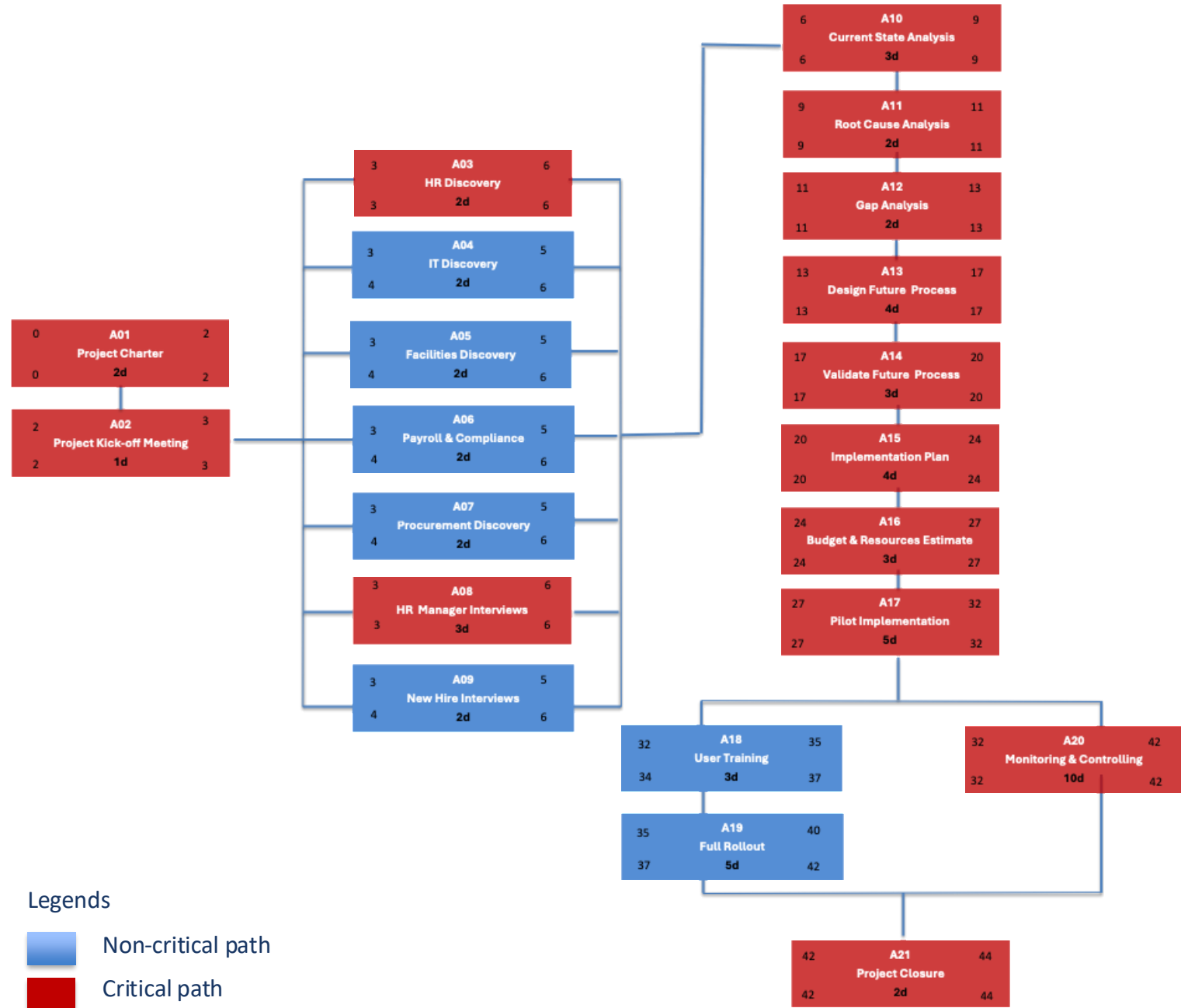
Breaks the improvement process into major phases and key deliverables



It provides a structured view of the project scope and serves as the foundation for project planning, scheduling, resource allocation, and project execution.

Critical Path Network Diagram

Sequencing and dependencies mapped to identify critical path and total project timeline



Implementation Roadmap

Phased transformation approach

Phase 1 – Planning

- Project charter & governance
- Future-state design
- Implementation plan

Phase 2 – Build

- Portal configuration
- Workflow automation
- Documentation

Phase 3 – Pilot

- Pilot deployment
- User acceptance testing
- Process refinement

Phase 4 – Rollout

- Organization-wide rollout
- User training
- Change communications

Phase 5 – Hypercare

- Go-live support
- Performance monitoring
- Project closure

Project Governance

Governance framework and project controls

Artifact	Purpose
RAID Log	Tracked onboarding risks, issues, and dependencies
Decision Log	Documented key project decisions
Weekly Status Report	Communicated project progress
Change Log	Managed scope changes
Steering Committee	Approved key milestones and decisions

Lessons Learned

What was done well and what is to be done differently in future

01

Parallel workflows require rethinking dependencies, not just automating steps

02

Governance should scale with project size – lighter cadence fits this scope better

03

Change adoption matters as much as process redesign

Next Time

Define post-launch success metrics (e.g., new hire satisfaction score) to track beyond Day 10

Project Management Artifacts

*Key artifacts produced across
project lifecycle*

Planning

Project
Charter

Stakeholder
Register

Risk
Register

Execution

WBS

Project
Schedule

Critical
Path

Closure

Lessons
Learned

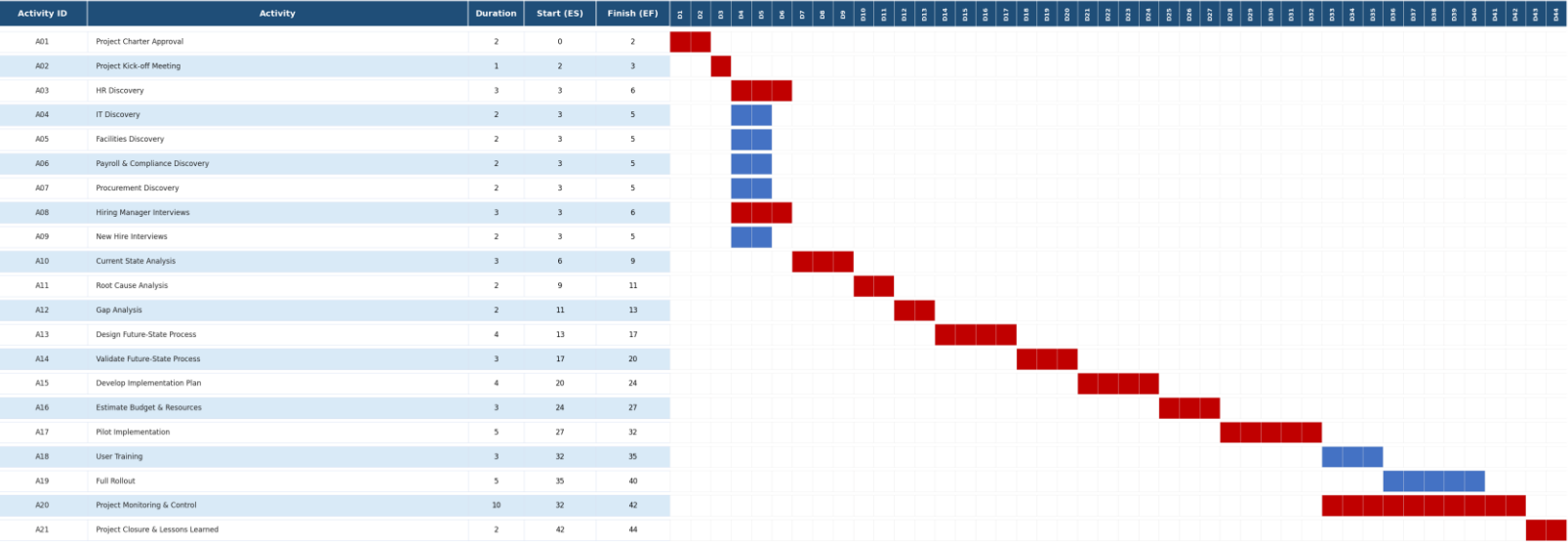
Project Closure
Report

Benefits
Review

Illustrative PM Artifacts

Gantt Schedule & Stakeholder Register

PROJECT GANTT SCHEDULE — DAY 1 TO DAY 44



█ Critical path █ Non-critical

Project: Employee Onboarding Improvement

Stakeholder	Role	Power	Interest	Key Concerns	Engagement Strategy	Communication Method	Frequency	Current Engagement Status
Project Sponsor	Director - Human Resources	High	High	Business outcomes, budget approval, project success	Manage Closely	Steering Committee Meeting	Weekly	Engaged
HR Lead	Human Resources	High	High	Hiring experience, process efficiency, policy compliance	Manage Closely	Workshop / Weekly Meeting	Weekly	Engaged
IT Lead	Information Technology	Medium	High	Account provisioning, system access, hardware readiness	Keep Informed	Team Meeting	Weekly	Engaged
Facilities Lead	Facilities Management	Medium	High	Workspace allocation, ID cards, seating	Keep Informed	Email / Meeting	Weekly	Engaged
Payroll Lead	Payroll	Medium	High	Payroll setup, statutory compliance	Keep Informed	Weekly Meeting	Weekly	Engaged
Compliance Lead	Legal & Compliance	Medium	High	Regulatory compliance, documentation	Keep Informed	Review Meeting	Weekly	Engaged
Procurement Lead	Procurement	Medium	High	Laptop and equipment procurement	Keep Informed	Email	Weekly	Engaged
Hiring Managers	Business Functions	High	High	Candidate readiness, joining timelines	Manage Closely	Workshops / Review Meetings	Bi-weekly	Engaged
New Hire Representatives	Employee Representatives	Low	High	Smooth onboarding experience, communication, visibility	Consult	Survey / Feedback Session	At Key Milestones	Engaged

Illustrative PM Artifacts

RAID Log & Risk Register

	Project: Employee Onboarding Improvement						
ID	Type	Description	Impact	Probability	Owner	Response/Mitigation	Status
R1	Risk	Delays in procurement of laptops and accessories	High	Medium	Procurement	Order equipment early and track weekly	Open
R2	Risk	Background verification takes longer than expected	High	Medium	Compliance	Start verification immediately after acceptance	Open
R3	Risk	Hiring Manager approval delays	High	High	Hiring Manager	Set approval SLA and automated reminders	Open
R4	Risk	Inconsistent onboarding processes across locations	Medium	High	HR	Standardize onboarding checklist and SOP	Open
A1	Assumption	Departments will provide historical onboarding data on time	Medium	Medium	All Stakeholders	Confirm availability during discovery	Open
I1	Issue	Different departments define "onboarding completion" differently	High	High	Sponsor	Agree on one standard project definitiin	Open
D1	Dependency	Employee submits required documents before joining	High	Medium	Employee	Send reminders and checklists before joining	Open
D2	Dependency	External background verification vendor completes checks on time	High	Medium	Compliance	Monitor vendor SLA	Open
D3	Dependency	Hiring Manager approves hardware and software requirements	High	Medium	Hiring Manager	Approval required before procurement begins	Open
	RAID Review Frequency: Weekly Project Status Meeting						

Project: Employee Onboarding Improvement - Risk Register										
Risk ID	Category	Risk Description	Probability	Impact	Risk Score	Risk Owner	Response Strategy	Mitigation / Contingency	Status	Trigger
RR-001	Schedule	Background verification delays	Medium	High	6	Compliance Lead	Mitigate	Initiate checks immediately after offer acceptance	Open	Vendor turnaround exceeds SLA
RR-002	Resource	Hiring Manager approval delays	High	High	9	HR Manager	Mitigate	Approval SLA and automated reminders	Open	Approvals exceed 2 working days
RR-003	Procurement	Laptop delivery delays	Medium	High	6	IT Manager	Mitigate	Order equipment in advance; maintain buffer stock	Open	Supplier misses committed date
RR-004	Scope	Unplanned onboarding requirements	Medium	Medium	4	Project Manager	Avoid	Route requests through Change Control process	Monitoring	Stakeholder requests outside baseline scope
RR-005	Compliance	Mandatory policy changes during project	Low	High	3	Compliance Lead	Accept	Assess impact and raise charge request if needed	Monitoring	New regulatory guidance issued
RR-006	Adoption	Low user adoption of new process	Medium	Medium	4	HR Lead	Mitigate	Training sessions and user guides	Open	Negative pilot feedback

Project Outcomes & PM Capabilities

*Business outcomes achieved and
project management
competencies demonstrated*

Business Outcomes



50% reduction in onboarding cycle

Standardized onboarding process

Parallel cross-functional workflows

Improved new hire readiness

PM Competencies

Project Planning & Governance

Stakeholder Management

Risk Management

Change Management

Process Improvement

